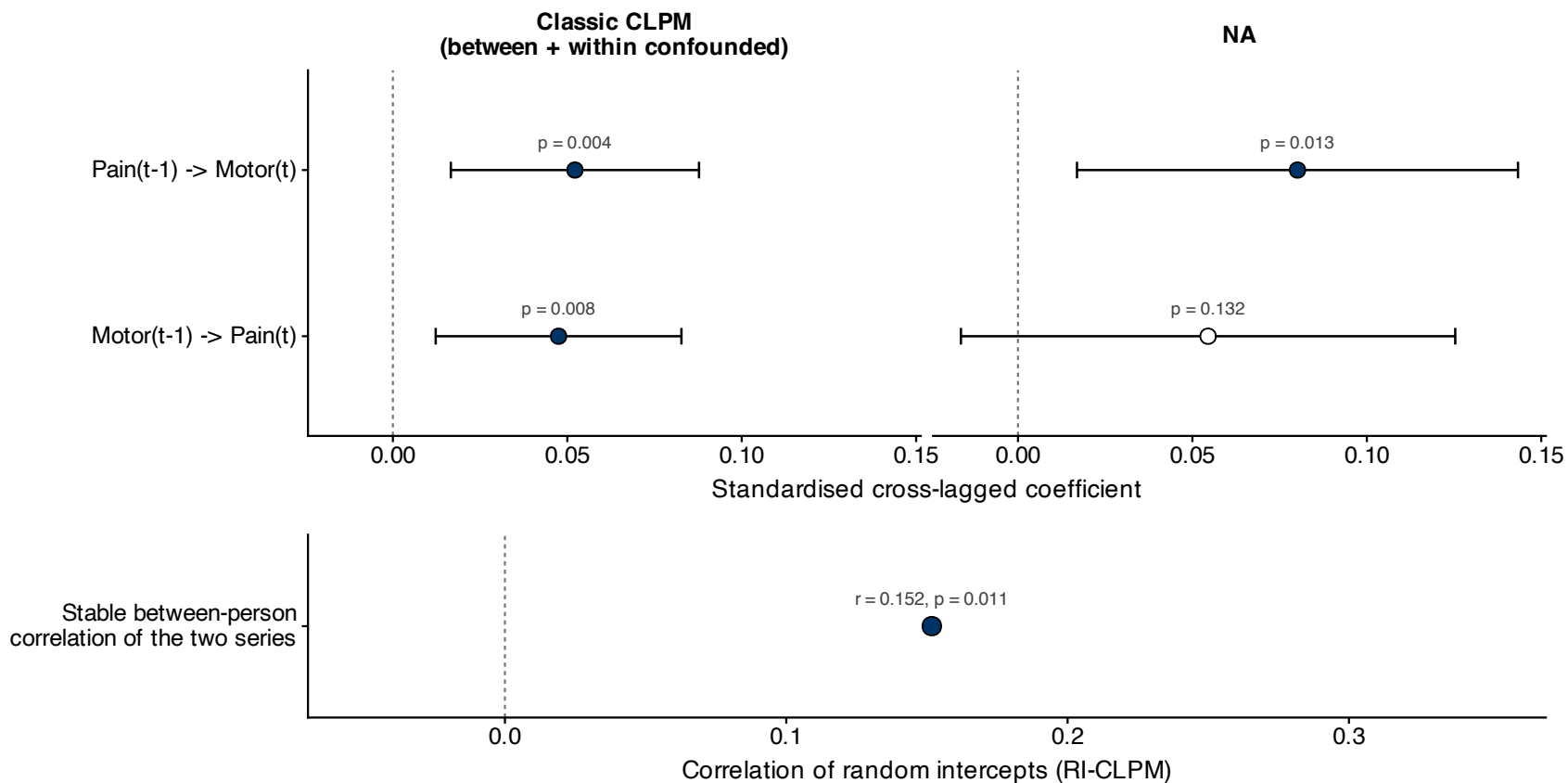


Figure 2. Direction of the pain and motor severity relationship



Left panels: the classic cross-lagged panel model makes both directions significant. Right: once stable between-person differences are separated by random intercepts, the motor-to-pain path is null and only a modest pain-to-motor path remains, which does not survive the robustness checks reported in the text. Bottom: the two series covary stably across people. Filled circles denote $p < 0.05$. Model fit favours the random-intercept model (CFI 0.963 vs 0.877; RMSEA 0.077 vs 0.114; SRMR 0.044 vs 0.112).